

HOUSE BILL 1525

By Stinnett

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 40,
relative to victims of crime.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 40-35-115, is amended by adding the following new subsection:

(e) If the defendant is convicted of two (2) or more offenses, irrespective of whether the multiple offenses were part of a single criminal episode, involving more than one (1) victim that is a minor, then the court shall order the sentences to run consecutively unless the court finds by a preponderance of the evidence that the facts of the case do not warrant the imposition of consecutive sentences and the imposition of consecutive sentences would not be in the best interest of justice.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it, and applies to offenses committed on or after that date.